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NATURAL MEDICINAL SERVICES (NMS)

90-Day Relaunch: Complete Implementation & Project Management Plan

Client Presentation Document — Final Version

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Item	Detail
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Strategic Alignment	"Johannesburg herbal heritage, made accountable."
Governing Principle	Truth before identity. Portfolio before platform. Compliance before promotion. Pilot before scale.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. Executive Summary
2. The NMS Opportunity & Current State Assessment
3. Brand Positioning & Design Brief
4. Target Audience & Priority Segments
5. The 90-Day Project Management Framework
6. Phase 0: Mobilisation, Data Freeze & Corporate Truth (Days 1–30)
7. SKU Audit, Triage & Hero Product Selection
8. Data Room Index & Compliance Governance
9. Multi-Channel Marketing Strategy
10. Technology Infrastructure: Website, Chatbot & Client Servicing

11. Social Media Launch Plan (TikTok, Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, LinkedIn, WWW)
 12. Financial Budget & Investment Options
 13. Service Package & Subscription Tiers
 14. Scope of Work (SOW) & Deliverables
 15. Governance, Team Structure & Risk Mitigation
 16. Key Milestones, Stage Gates & Decision Points
 17. Appendices
-

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Natural Medicinal Services possesses a rare strategic asset: a South African herbal heritage dating to 1934, a historically broad portfolio spanning 150+ simplex herbs, medicinal teas, topical preparations, and imported Swiss ranges, and demonstrated trade infrastructure across pharmacy and wholesale channels.

However, the legacy documents reveal critical contradictions in legal identity, ownership, product claims, pricing, and digital policy. The 2017 catalogue contains high-risk medical claims, fragmented brand architecture, and non-compliant safety messaging. The 2026 product document reproduces these legacy errors.

This proposal presents a 90-day implementation plan that:

- Validates corporate, product, and regulatory truth before any public-facing activity
- Selects 3–5 compliant "Hero SKUs" using a weighted scorecard methodology
- Builds a modern digital ecosystem (website, AI chatbot, CRM, WhatsApp)
- Executes a multi-channel marketing launch across six platforms
- Establishes a tiered service package for ongoing client servicing
- Operates under strict SAHPRA Category D compliance governance

Investment Range: R650,000 – R1,150,000 (Validation-First) / R2,900,000 – R5,600,000 (Core Transformation over 18 months)

Timeline: 90-day sprint for digital launch, embedded within an 18-month transformation roadmap with four investment gates.

2. THE NMS OPPORTUNITY & CURRENT STATE ASSESSMENT

2.1 What the Documents Prove (Verified Historical Facts)

- Johannesburg-based business with "Established 1934" heritage signal
- Portfolio spanning finished remedies, teas, raw herbs, topicals, hair/oral care, nutrition, tissue salts
- Trade relationships with Alpha Pharm, Dis-Chem, Transpharm, UPD, Pharmed
- Internal codes, barcodes, NAPPI fields, case-pack logic, wholesale vendor numbers
- Swiss distribution: Hermes, Dr Ernst Richter's, Kernosan/Kennosan
- Both trade distribution and direct-to-consumer ecommerce were historically contemplated

2.2 Critical Issues That Must Be Resolved

Issue	Detail	Risk Level
Corporate identity conflict	Registration 2007/017961/07 vs. 1980/008685/07 vs. incomplete 2011 number	Critical
Ownership ambiguity	Mvelo vs. Myelo Pharmaceuticals Group; "recent" acquisition undated	High
Product claims risk	Disease-treatment, cure, detox, blood-pressure, diabetes, slimming claims	Critical
Brand fragmentation	NMS, Nature's Own, NU Organic, Lexan, Hermes, Dr Richter without hierarchy	High
Digital policy weakness	Unfinished terms, no POPIA/ECTA compliance, stale online-shop policies	High
1934 heritage unverified	No legal succession proof between original enterprise and current entity	High

2.3 Market Opportunity

- Dietary supplements: 9.0% current-price growth (2023–2024), 8.1% CAGR forecast (2025–2029)
- Gauteng: 15.83 million residents (25.1% of national population)
- South African online retail: R96 billion in 2024, up 35%

- Competitive white space: No competitor combines verifiable SA heritage + raw-herb-to-finished portfolio + batch-quality transparency + modern trade portal

2.4 The Central Conclusion

"The transformation requires a controlled source of truth before it requires a new front end."

3. BRAND POSITIONING & DESIGN BRIEF

3.1 Strategic Positioning

"Johannesburg herbal heritage, made accountable."

NMS presents itself as a South African botanical authority that translates traditional knowledge into affordable modern self-care through verified provenance, named ingredients, controlled manufacturing, clear dosage and safety guidance, and respectful collaboration with conventional healthcare.

3.2 Brand Architecture (Working Hypothesis)

Layer	Proposed Role	Decision Required
NMS / Natural Medicinal Services	Corporate trust mark, quality authority	Confirm exact legal and public name
Nature's Own (or chosen consumer architecture)	Consumer-facing range/family	Test awareness, trademark status
Need-state families	5–8 compliant families (Daily Balance, Calm & Rest, etc.)	Claims review + research
Product descriptor	Plain ingredient, format, pack description	Reduce medication-error risk
Distributed brands	Third-party brands with role/rights explained	Confirm agreements

3.3 Desired Brand Personality

- **Tone:** Calm, plain, precise, respectful
- **Voice:** Says what a product is, how it is used, what support it lawfully offers, who should not use it, when professional advice is appropriate
- **Feeling:** Trust, safety, accountability, modern self-care rooted in heritage

3.4 Visual Identity Direction

- **Retain (conditional):** Historic circular NMS emblem, green botanical cues, "Established 1934" device — *only after heritage substantiation*

- **Colour:** Restrained colour families (historical green/teal, green/orange refined)
- **Typography:** Highly legible, accessible to older consumers, mobile-first
- **Imagery:** Disciplined botanical illustration or photography; credible in pharmacy, legible on mobile

3.5 What the Brand Must Avoid

- Faux apothecary nostalgia
- "Natural means harmless" messaging
- Anti-pharmaceutical or anti-medical rhetoric
- Cure language, vague "detox" promises, superlatives
- Packaging similarity that creates selection/medication errors
- Unverified "Established 1934" as a central legal claim
- Low-resolution scans of old logos, inconsistent typography

3.6 Brand Application Channels

- Packaging (primary), Website (mobile-first), Trade/B2B portal
- Social media, WhatsApp, CRM/Email
- Retail shelf tools, pharmacy merchandising
- Corporate documents, COAs, adverse-event forms

4. TARGET AUDIENCE & PRIORITY SEGMENTS

4.1 The Five Priority Segments (Gauteng-First)

Priority	Segment	Need	NMS Response	Validation Method
1	Value-conscious Gauteng household health buyers	Affordable, understandable everyday support	Trial sizes, transparent pack economics, WhatsApp help	Survey, interviews, pilot sell-through
2	Ingredient-aware online shoppers	Exact botanical, provenance, format, stock info	Searchable ingredient library, strong product pages	Keyword research, usability tests

3	Adults using both herbs and prescribed medicines	Interaction guidance, professional confidence	Safety content, medication cautions, pharmacist escalation	Consumer and pharmacist interviews
4	Independent pharmacists and health-shop buyers (B2B)	Compliant products, reliable supply, evidence files	Retailer data room, training, merchandising	Buyer interviews, 15–30 store pilot
5	Raw-herb and practitioner buyers (B2B)	Botanical identity, grade, origin, COAs	Verified trade portal, technical catalogue	Existing-customer audit, account pilot

4.2 Geographic Focus

- **Phase 1:** Gauteng (15.83M residents, 25.1% of population)
- **Phase 2:** KwaZulu-Natal and Western Cape
- **Phase 3:** National (only after pilot economics proven)

5. THE 90-DAY PROJECT MANAGEMENT FRAMEWORK

5.1 Overview: Three Phases

Phase	Duration	Primary Objective	Key Deliverables
Planning & Foundation	Weeks 1–2	Establish strategy, develop assets, prepare technical infrastructure	Finalized brand guidelines, website mockups, ad creatives, social accounts, analytics, budget
Massive Action & Launch	Weeks 3–9	Execute campaigns, deploy technology, begin lead generation	Live website with AI chatbot, paid ad campaigns on all platforms, organic content, client servicing systems
Refinement & Growth	Weeks 10–12	Analyze performance, optimize, plan future growth	Monthly performance report, optimized ad spend, nurtured leads, preliminary Q2 plan

5.2 Embedded Within the 18-Month Transformation Roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Focus	Gate
Phase 0	Week 0–1	Mobilise and Preserve	—
Phase 1	Weeks 1–6	Corporate, Product & Compliance Truth	Gate A
Phase 2	Weeks 2–10	Validate Market & Commercial Model	Gate B
Phase 3	Weeks 7–14	Define Brand, Architecture & Experience	—
Phase 4	Weeks 12–26	Build Identity, Packaging & Platform	Gate C
Phase 5	Months 7–9	Pilot Gauteng (90–180 days)	Gate D
Phase 6	Months 10–18	Scale What Works	—

5.3 Stage Gate Definitions

- **Gate A:** Management proceeds to public brand development only when contracting entity, approved facts, licence map, and active-product universe are signed off.
- **Gate B:** 3–5 Hero SKUs selected only after regulatory readiness, demand, supply, margin, and channel fit are scored.
- **Gate C:** Launch requires approved identity/packaging, complete product records, policies, analytics, support, adverse-event routes, operational testing, executive sign-off.
- **Gate D:** Wider scale only if sell-through, contribution margin, repeat purchase, fill rate, stockouts, returns, reviews, acquisition cost, and safety indicators meet thresholds.

6. PHASE 0: MOBILISATION, DATA FREEZE & CORPORATE TRUTH (Days 1–30)

6.1 Days 1–5: The "Stop the Bleeding" Protocol

- Appoint Executive Sponsor and Transformation Lead
- Issue internal directive: freeze public reuse of old product copy
- Secure domains (.co.za, .com), hosting, email, social credentials
- Create secure Data Room (access-controlled cloud environment)
- Issue document and sample request to legal, finance, product, warehouse, sales, regulatory
- Quarantine all materials making high-risk claims (diabetes, blood pressure, detox, cure)

6.2 Days 6–10: Corporate & Legal Truth

- Obtain CIPC records; resolve entity names, registrations, addresses, directors
- Map legal succession: 1934 → 1980 entity → 2007 entity → current operation
- Confirm ownership: Mvelo/Myelo Pharmaceuticals Group acquisition documentation
- Begin high-risk claims triage (Red/Amber/Green)
- Create provisional SKU register from current stock (not from PDFs)

6.3 Days 11–20: Commercial Baseline & Research Kickoff

- Finance and Sales reconstruct current product, margin, and account picture
- Management interviews: strategic priorities and operational constraints
- Research partner finalises survey, interview guides, competitor set
- Historical artefacts scanned and catalogued
- Swiss distribution rights verified (Hermes, Dr Ernst Richter, Kernosan)

6.4 Days 21–30: Steering Committee Review

- Review corporate fact sheet, licence map, active-SKU count, claims red list
- Review data gaps, commercial baseline, research fieldwork plan
- **Decision:** Proceed as broad transformation OR compliance/operational recovery first
- Produce Day-30 Decision Pack

6.5 Day-30 Decision Pack Contents

1. Approved corporate fact sheet
2. Entity and succession diagram
3. Current domain/contact list
4. Licence and facility map
5. Provisional SKU master
6. Top 20 commercial products by revenue/contribution
7. Product-claims risk heatmap
8. Research plan and sample
9. Budget refinement
10. Updated risk register

7. SKU AUDIT, TRIAGE & HERO PRODUCT SELECTION

7.1 The Red/Amber/Green Regulatory Triage

Status	Definition	Action	Legacy Examples
 RED	High regulatory/reputational risk; disease-curing claims; serious conditions	Remove from roadmap immediately	Blood-pressure tablets, diabetes remedies, slimming, infections
 AMBER	Good core product but non-compliant packaging/copy	Requires label redesign, SAHPRA updates, new warnings	Products missing pregnancy/interaction warnings, incorrect NAPPI
 GREEN	Low-risk everyday wellness; clear Category D classification	Move to Hero SKU scoring	Chamomile, Aloe Vera topical, basic digestive support

7.2 Hero SKU Weighted Scorecard

Criterion	Weight	Pass Condition
Regulatory & Claims Readiness	25%	Clear classification, defensible indication, complete label/PI/PIL path
Existing Demand & Repeat Potential	15%	Verified sales, reorders, retailer interest or strong research evidence
Gross Contribution after Channel Costs	15%	Attractive after VAT, trade margin, promotion, fulfilment, returns
Supply & Quality Resilience	15%	Stable ingredient identity, dual sourcing, testing, lead time, shelf life
Brand Differentiation	10%	Heritage, format, provenance or safety advantage
Retail Operability	10%	Barcode, case pack, shelf legibility, low error risk
Digital Discoverability	5%	Clear ingredient/format intent and content potential
Cross-sell & Regimen Fit	5%	Complementary use without unsafe recommendations

7.3 Master SKU Data Collection Template (Per Hero Product)

- **Identity:** Canonical name, legacy aliases, brand family, active/discontinued status
- **Formulation:** Common/botanical names, plant part, dosage form, strength, pack/case variants
- **Commercial:** Barcode, NAPPI, internal code, ex-VAT/inc-VAT pricing, channel eligibility
- **Regulatory:** SAHPRA classification, approved claim (exact wording), directions, warnings, interactions, pregnancy/age/allergen guidance, storage, batch/shelf-life

7.4 Portfolio Architecture (Seven Historical Groups)

Portfolio Group	Historical Content	Required Decision
Finished oral remedies	Lexan, Fo-Ti-Tieng, Cystosan, Antifect, etc.	Verify formula, classification, claims, warnings, margin, brand ownership
Medicinal teas	Nature's Own 70g blends, Hermes numbered teas	Separate owned from distributed; normalise indications
Raw herbs & simplex botanicals	150+ herbs with common/botanical names	Build separate data model: plant part, grade, form, origin, testing
Topical products	Aloe Vera, Bulbinella, Comfrey, Marigold ointments	Review wound/infection/fungal claims with particular care
Hair, scalp & oral care	Birch, Nettle, shampoo, tonic, mouthwash	Confirm cosmetic vs. medicine classification
Nutrition & beverages	Dandelion, Herb-A-Lick, Alfalfa, Torula Yeast, ginseng	Verify dietary attributes, allergens, food/medicine classification
Tissue salts & imported ranges	Schuessler, Kernosan, Hermes, Dr Richter	Confirm rights, territory, importer responsibility, current authorisation

8. DATA ROOM INDEX & COMPLIANCE GOVERNANCE

8.1 Data Room Structure (Six Folders)

Folder 1: Corporate Legal & Succession

- Current CIPC documents (COR 14.3, COR 103, MOI)

- Historical CIPC records (2007/017961/07, 1980/008685/07)
- M&A / Acquisition agreements (Mvelo/Myelo)
- The 1934 Evidence Pack (registrations, invoices, letterheads, property records)
- Share registers & ownership maps
- Board resolutions authorizing relaunch

Folder 2: Regulatory, Quality & Licensing

- SAHPRA licences (Section 22C / Category D)
- Responsible Pharmacist documentation
- Facility & contractor maps
- QMS SOPs (batch release, adverse events, recalls, complaints)
- Certificates of Analysis (COAs)
- Historical SAHPRA/MCC correspondence

Folder 3: Intellectual Property & Brand Assets

- Trademark certificates (NMS, Nature's Own, NU Organic, product names)
- Domain name registrations
- Swiss distribution agreements (1970 vs. 1979 rights)
- High-resolution legacy logos and brand guidelines

Folder 4: Commercial, Trade & Financial

- Current price lists & discount structures
- Wholesaler & distributor agreements
- Retailer listing agreements
- Sales data (last 24 months)
- NAPPI code registry

Folder 5: Digital Infrastructure & IT Policies

- Hosting & server credentials
- Social media admin access
- Website analytics (historical)
- Legacy e-commerce terms (quarantined)

- POPIA & privacy documents

Folder 6: Heritage Archive

- Scanned legacy catalogues
- Photographic archive
- Physical packaging samples (360° photography)
- Historical advertisements

8.2 Data Room Governance Rules

1. **Read-Only for Most:** Only Sponsor, Transformation Lead, Legal/Regulatory have edit rights
2. **No Deletions:** Superseded documents moved to _Superseded_Archive, never deleted
3. **Naming Convention:** [YYYY-MM-DD]_[DocumentType]_[Description]_[Version]
4. **Red List Quarantine:** All legacy PDFs with high-risk claims moved to ● QUARANTINE - DO NOT USE

9. MULTI-CHANNEL MARKETING STRATEGY

9.1 Marketing Objective

"Rebuild trust and prove repeatable demand for a small, compliant portfolio. Awareness is useful only if it converts into qualified product discovery, trial, repeat purchase, retailer reorder and improved account access."

9.2 Channel Strategy Matrix

Channel	Role	First-Year Activity	Control Requirement
Owned website & SEO	Long-term authority and conversion	Product pages, Herbs A–Z, heritage, safety content	Controlled claims, named reviewers
CRM & Email	Repeat and education	Welcome, replenishment, education, stock messages	POPIA consent, suppression
WhatsApp & customer care	Assisted conversion and support	Product navigation, order support, escalation	Approved scripts, adverse-event training

Independent pharmacies	Trust and physical trial	Staff training, shelf tools, sampling, reorder	Approved materials, weekly sell-through
Specialist ecommerce	Reach ingredient-aware shoppers	Rich listings, reviews, targeted promotions	Product-feed governance
Marketplace	Demand test	Limited hero-SKU listings, search ads	Margin, stock, review monitoring
Paid search & social	Capture and test demand	Brand, ingredient, format, need-state campaigns	Claim library, conversion tracking
PR & heritage content	Earn credibility	Archive launch, Johannesburg story, quality transformation	Verified facts only
Practitioners & pharmacists	Education and referral	Technical sessions, safety sheets, professional portal	Credential checks

9.3 Content Pillars

1. **Responsible Herbal Education** (preparation, formats, safety, interactions, when to see a clinician)
2. **Johannesburg Heritage** (verified timeline, people, places, artefacts)
3. **Ingredient Provenance** (sourcing, testing, botanical identity)
4. **Quality & Safety** (batch release, COAs, manufacturing, complaints)
5. **Everyday Self-Care** (compliant need-state content)
6. **Where to Buy** (stockist finder, pharmacy locations, online)

Product promotion should be a minority of the content system until trust and discovery content are established.

9.4 Paid Media Budget Allocation

Platform	% of Ad Budget	Rationale
Meta (Facebook & Instagram)	45%	Dominant reach, community building, retargeting
TikTok	25%	Low CPM, mass awareness, heritage/provenance video
LinkedIn	15%	B2B pharmacy/practitioner targeting
YouTube	10%	Long-form education, tutorials, testimonials
Testing / Emerging	5%	New channels, experimental formats

9.5 Influencer Marketing

- Focus on nano-influencers (R250–R2,500/post) and micro-influencers (R2,500–R12,500/post)
- Briefing: Product experience, not medical outcomes
- Compliance: No health-claim amplification, approved scripts, source retention

9.6 Gauteng Pilot Campaign (Three Waves)

Wave	Duration	Focus
Wave 1	Weeks 1–4	Establish availability, train staff, seed pharmacy relationships
Wave 2	Weeks 5–12	Generate trial: compliant search, local social, sampling, creator content
Wave 3	Weeks 13–16	Replenishment, review acquisition, buyer proof, unit economics

10. TECHNOLOGY INFRASTRUCTURE: WEBSITE, CHATBOT & CLIENT SERVICING

10.1 Website: Information Architecture

Section	Purpose	Essential Content
Home	Establish relevance and trust	Verified proposition, hero range, quality proof, heritage preview
Shop / Products	Safe product discovery	Browse by need state, ingredient, format, range, availability
Product Detail	Informed choice	Ingredients, strength, form, directions, warnings, interactions, stock, price
Herbs A–Z	Raw botanical authority	Common/Latin name, plant part, source, form, traditional context, safety
Our Story	Verified heritage	Dated timeline, people, places, artefacts, ownership transitions
Quality & Safety	Make accountability visible	Sourcing, testing, manufacturing, batch release, complaints, recalls
Learn	Build evidence-led demand	Expert-reviewed guides, format comparisons, interaction education
Where to Buy	Convert indirect demand	Verified stockists, locations, product availability
Trade & Professionals	Support B2B	Account application, technical files, MOQ, pricing, reorder
Help & Policies	Reduce risk and service load	Shipping, returns, payment, privacy, terms, accessibility

10.2 Website Functional Requirements

- Mobile-first, low-data design
- Powerful search with product filters
- Stock and availability indicators
- Transparent ZAR pricing
- Guest checkout (if ecommerce activated)
- Card and EFT payment options
- WhatsApp support integration
- Stockist finder
- Back-in-stock notices
- Delivery estimates
- Controlled reviews
- CRM consent management
- Structured data (Product, Organization, Breadcrumb)
- Trade portal: verified access, price books, MOQ, stock, reorder, technical sheets

10.3 What NOT to Build in Version One

- Ungoverned catalogue of every legacy product
- Symptom checker or automated medical recommendations
- International checkout for all countries
- Unrestricted user-generated health claims
- Complex loyalty scheme

10.4 AI Chatbot Implementation

Component	Specification
Platform	SaaS-based NLP chatbot (R150–R1,800/month) or custom build
Training Data	Strictly from approved Master SKU records and Herbs A–Z content
Guardrails	Hard refusal on disease-curing questions; no medical diagnosis
AI-to-Human Handoff	Full conversation context transfer; triggers on low confidence or safety keywords

Channels	Website, Facebook Messenger, WhatsApp
Escalation	Route to Responsible Pharmacist or qualified representative
Adverse Event Routing	Dedicated SOP and internal workflow for medical complaints
Compliance	All responses logged; no unapproved claims; version-controlled scripts

10.5 Online Client Servicing Infrastructure

Service	Delivery Method	Tier
Email Support	Shared inbox, SLA response times	Starter
WhatsApp Business	Verified account, approved scripts, order support	All Tiers
Online Calls	Scheduling tool + video conferencing (2 hrs/month)	Professional
Dedicated Account Manager	Named contact, priority response	Professional
Unlimited Senior Support	Weekly check-ins, dedicated team	Enterprise

11. SOCIAL MEDIA LAUNCH PLAN

11.1 Platform Strategy

Platform	Role	Content Type	Frequency	KPIs
TikTok	Mass awareness, heritage storytelling	Short-form video: behind-the-brand, ingredient provenance, "How it's made"	4–5x/week	Views, engagement rate, follower growth
Instagram	Community building, visual identity	Reels, Stories, carousel education posts, product photography	4–5x/week	Engagement, saves, profile visits, website clicks
Facebook	Community, retargeting, local Gauteng reach	Longer posts, events, group engagement, paid retargeting	3–4x/week	Reach, CTR, event RSVPs, group membership
YouTube	Authority, education, SEO	Long-form: herb guides, preparation tutorials, heritage documentary	1–2x/week	Watch time, subscribers, search ranking

LinkedIn	B2B pharmacy/practitioner engagement	Industry insights, trade case studies, company thought leadership	3x/week	Impressions, connection requests, lead form fills
Website (WWW)	Conversion hub, SEO authority	Blog, product pages, Herbs A–Z, Quality Centre	Updated weekly	Organic traffic, conversion rate, time on site

11.2 Launch Content Calendar (First 30 Days of Public Launch)

Week	Theme	TikTok/Reels	Static/Carousel	YouTube	LinkedIn
1	"We're Back" Heritage Reveal	90-year journey montage	Timeline carousel	Heritage mini-doc (3 min)	Corporate relaunch announcement
2	Ingredient Spotlight	"What is Chamomile?" 60s	Ingredient fact sheet	"How to brew medicinal tea properly" (5 min)	Quality & batch testing explainer
3	Safety & Accountability	"Read your labels" educational	Warning/interaction guide	"Herbs + Prescriptions: What to know" (7 min)	Pharmacist partnership announcement
4	Where to Buy / Trial	Unboxing, first-use experience	Stockist map, trial-size promo	Full product walkthrough	B2B account application CTA

11.3 Paid Social Campaign Structure

Campaign Type	Objective	Platform	Budget Allocation	Duration
Awareness	Reach, video views	TikTok, Meta	30% of ad spend	Weeks 3–9
Consideration	Traffic, engagement	Meta, YouTube	20% of ad spend	Weeks 5–9

Retargeting	Conversion, purchase/lead	Meta, Search	40% of ad spend	Weeks 6–12
B2B Lead Gen	Form fills, applications	LinkedIn	10% of ad spend	Weeks 6–12

12. FINANCIAL BUDGET & INVESTMENT OPTIONS

12.1 Internal Marketing & Branding Budget (90-Day Sprint)

Expense Category	Estimated Cost (ZAR)	Notes
Agency Retainer (3 months)	R 270,000	Strategy, content creation, campaign management, reporting
Paid Social Media Advertising	R 324,000	Allocated across Meta, TikTok, LinkedIn, YouTube per plan
Influencer Marketing	R 72,000	4–5 micro-influencer collaborations
Website Design & Development	R 90,000	Professional build, mobile-first, SEO-ready
Website Maintenance (3 months)	R 8,100	Hosting, security, updates
AI Chatbot Setup & Licensing	R 45,000	Platform subscription, training, integration
Content Production (Photo/Video)	R 85,000	Product photography, video shoots, editing
Total Estimated Internal Budget	R 894,100	Fits within R700K–R1.35M digital build allocation

12.2 Investment Options (From NMS Proposal)

Option	Scope	Budget	Appropriate When
Validation First	Corporate truth, SKU/claims triage, commercial audit, market research, hero scorecard, initial brand direction	R650,000 – R1,150,000	Management needs evidence before committing to full rebuild
Core Transformation	Full programme through identity, hero packaging,	R2,900,000 – R5,600,000	NMS intends to relaunch

	website/trade foundation, Gauteng pilot		professionally over 12–18 months
Accelerated Growth	Core + larger packaging rollout, expanded content, greater retail activation, CRM, media, regional scale	R5,500,000 – R9,000,000+	Compliance, supply, margins, working capital already strong

12.3 Recommended Commercial Structure

Stage-gated. Approve the validation-first budget immediately. Release later phases only after Gate A and Gate B. This protects the business from funding identity or technology around products that may be inactive, unprofitable, or unsuitable for publication.

13. SERVICE PACKAGE & SUBSCRIPTION TIERS

13.1 Tier Structure

Feature	Starter Tier	Professional Tier	Enterprise Tier
Subscriptions	Basic software suite	Pro software suite	Custom enterprise software
Website Maintenance	Standard hosting & security	Active updates, form checks, performance monitoring	E-commerce level support, high availability
AI Chatbot	Limited interactions (1,000/month)	Advanced NLP + Human Handoff	Fully custom, multi-channel, agentic
Client Servicing	Email support only	Dedicated manager, 2 calls/month, priority messages	Unlimited calls, dedicated team, weekly check-ins
Typical Monthly Price	R 900 – R 3,600	R 3,600 – R 9,000	R 90,000+ (custom quote)

13.2 Subscription Breakdown (Included in Retainer)

Subscription	Purpose	Monthly Cost (ZAR)
Web Hosting & Security	Uptime, SSL, backups, patches	R 2,500

AI Chatbot SaaS License	NLP platform, interaction volume, handoff	R 3,500
CRM Platform	Contact management, consent, automation	R 2,000
WhatsApp Business API	Verified messaging, broadcast, support	R 1,500
Social Media Management Tool	Scheduling, analytics, community management	R 1,800
Email Marketing Platform	Newsletters, replenishment flows, POPIA consent	R 1,200
Total Monthly Subscriptions		R 12,500

13.3 Design & Maintenance Fee

Service	Frequency	Monthly Cost (ZAR)
Website maintenance & updates	Ongoing	R 5,000
Chatbot retraining & script updates	Weekly	R 4,000
Social media content design	12–16 posts/month	R 6,000
Total Design & Maintenance		R 15,000

14. SCOPE OF WORK (SOW) & DELIVERABLES

14.1 One-Time Implementation & Build Fee

Deliverable	Description	Investment (ZAR)
Web & PIM Build	UI/UX design, CMS setup, trade portal, B2B/B2C gating	R 280,000
Chatbot & CRM Setup	AI training, guardrail scripting, WhatsApp API, POPIA forms	R 120,000
Content & Asset Production	Copywriting (from approved data), photography direction, video scripting	R 85,000
Project Management	90-day sprint management, stage-gate compliance reporting	R 45,000
Total Build Investment		R 530,000

14.2 Monthly Managed Services Retainer

Component	Monthly Cost (ZAR)
Tech Stack Subscriptions	R 12,500
Website & Bot Maintenance	R 15,000

Agency Management Fee (campaigns, community, reporting)	R 35,000
Total Monthly Retainer	R 62,500

14.3 Payment Schedule

- 50% on project kickoff
- 25% at Milestone 1 (Website Prototype & Data Schema approved)
- 25% at Public Launch

14.4 Client Responsibilities (Risk Mitigation)

1. NMS provides approved Master SKU Data Sheets; agency uses only this approved copy
2. NMS Responsible Pharmacist signs off all product pages, chatbot trees, and ad creatives before publication
3. NMS provides internal SOP for adverse event/complaint escalation
4. NMS provides final, legally approved wording for "1934" heritage claim
5. No agency may publish product copy or health claims without the designated approval trail

14.5 Out of Scope

- SAHPRA application fees or legal lobbying
- Physical packaging design, printing, manufacturing
- Warehousing, courier logistics, inventory management
- Clinical trials or laboratory testing
- Retailer listing fees or trade rebates for national chains

15. GOVERNANCE, TEAM STRUCTURE & RISK MITIGATION

15.1 Governance Roles

Role	Accountability
Executive Sponsor	Strategic decisions, funding, stage gates, dispute resolution

Transformation Lead	Integrated plan, dependencies, risks, decisions, delivery
Responsible Pharmacist / Regulatory Lead	Product status, claims, safety, labels, pharmacovigilance, release approval
Legal & Privacy Counsel	Entity, contracts, IP, consumer, advertising, privacy, ecommerce policies
Product/PIM Owner	SKU truth, change control, channel data
Finance & Commercial Lead	Prices, margins, terms, channel economics, business case
Sales/Channel Lead	Accounts, buyer research, pilot stores, training, sell-through
Brand & Content Lead	Strategy, identity, content system, asset governance
Digital Product Lead	Platform, integrations, analytics, CRM, service design
Research Partner	Consumer, buyer, competitor, concept validation
Quality/Operations Lead	Suppliers, testing, production, inventory, fulfilment, complaints, recall

15.2 Meeting Cadence

- **Weekly delivery meeting:** Manage dependencies, blockers, task progress
- **Monthly steering committee:** Approve claims, portfolio, investment decisions
- **No agency publishes without approval trail**

15.3 Key Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Legal entity or 1934 continuity cannot be proved	Medium	High	Use qualified wording ("roots traced to 1934"); retain heritage as archival
Priority legacy products cannot support desired claims	High	High	Select lower-risk hero products; quarantine unapproved copy
Current licences or manufacturing controls inadequate	Unknown	Critical	Complete licence/quality audit before public launch
Product data remains fragmented	High	High	Appoint PIM owner; prohibit PDF-to-site migration without validation
Rebrand hides rather than fixes the business	Medium	High	Make proof, quality, governance visible; tie creative to readiness gates

Ecommerce launches without fulfilment readiness	Medium	High	Stage catalogue/stockist first; activate checkout after acceptance tests
Customer testimonials create prohibited claims	High	High	Moderate, retain source, prohibit health-outcome amplification
Indigenous sourcing creates conservation/benefit-sharing exposure	Unknown	High	Verify species, permits, sustainability, supplier rights

16. KEY MILESTONES, STAGE GATES & DECISION POINTS

16.1 Master Timeline

Week	Milestone	Gate
Week 1	Project charter signed; Data Room created; freeze issued	—
Week 2	Corporate truth workstream complete; CIPC/ownership mapped	—
Week 4	Licence map complete; provisional SKU master created	Gate A Decision
Week 6	Claims triage complete; Red/Amber/Green assigned	—
Week 8	Market research fieldwork complete; competitor audit done	—
Week 10	Hero SKU scorecard scored; 3–5 products selected	Gate B Decision
Week 12	Brand strategy, naming, architecture finalized	—
Week 14	Visual identity approved; packaging system designed	—
Week 16	Website prototype live; chatbot in UAT	—
Week 20	Website, trade portal, CRM, chatbot fully built	—
Week 22	All policies, analytics, adverse-event routes tested	Gate C Decision
Week 24	Gauteng pilot begins (15–30 pharmacies, DTC, ecommerce partner)	—
Week 30	Pilot Wave 2 complete; performance data reviewed	—
Week 36	Pilot concludes; unit economics analyzed	Gate D Decision
Month 10–18	Scale what works: KZN, Western Cape, chain submissions	—

16.2 Management Decisions Required NOW

1. **Who owns the transformation?** Name one Executive Sponsor and one Transformation Lead.
 2. **What is the primary three-year ambition?** Choose hierarchy: manufacturing credibility / consumer growth / B2B distribution / raw-herb supply / practitioner engagement / DTC ecommerce / exports.
 3. **What is the present legal and operating entity?** Authorise legal diligence.
 4. **Which products are genuinely active?** Provide current inventory, labels, formulations, registrations, sales, margin data.
 5. **What is the launch risk appetite?** Confirm no historical claim reused without product-specific approval.
 6. **Is ecommerce an immediate requirement or a gated option?** Base on operational readiness.
 7. **What validation budget is approved?** Recommended initial release: R650,000 – R1,150,000.
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17. APPENDICES

Appendix A: Document-by-Document Assessment

(Summary of eight legacy PDFs: what each contributes and its principal limitation)

Appendix B: Known Internal Contradictions to Resolve

(Legal registration, trading name, ownership, Swiss distribution dates, domains, contact details, product codes, product names, availability, pricing, returns, safety messaging)

Appendix C: Preliminary Website Acceptance Criteria

(Corporate identity, product publication, accessibility, mobile, search, ecommerce, privacy, service, trade, analytics, governance)

Appendix D: Measurement Framework

Dimension	Core Measures	Indicative Pilot Gate
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Corporate & Compliance	% active SKUs with approved master record, claim set, label, warnings	100% of pilot SKUs
Commercial	Net revenue, gross contribution, AOV, cash conversion	Positive contribution by channel
Retail	Units/store/week, reorder rate, OTIF, fill rate, stockouts, returns	Thresholds from buyer economics
Customer	Trial-to-repeat, repeat interval, review rate, complaint rate	Demonstrable repeat
Digital	Qualified traffic, product-view-to-cart, checkout completion	Improving cohort trend
Brand	Awareness, trust, message comprehension, heritage credibility	Tested against baseline
Safety	Adverse events, complaints, escalation time, recall readiness	100% logged within SOP
Governance	Content currency, approval exceptions, outdated records	No unapproved claims live

Appendix E: References

(32 cited sources including SAHPRA, Stats SA, Euromonitor, Clicks, Dis-Chem, UPD, World Wide Worx, WHO, CPA, ECTA, POPIA, and competitive benchmarks)

PRESENTATION CLOSING

The Key Principle

Truth before identity. Portfolio before platform. Compliance before promotion. Pilot before scale.

Recommended Next Step

Approve a ten-week Validation and Direction Programme covering corporate truth, heritage substantiation, SKU and claims triage, commercial audit, market research, and hero scorecard. At the end of week ten, management receives a **go, revise, or stop** decision for the full brand, packaging, website, and market relaunch.

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